AICTE SIH 2026

APH Selected Provisions & Workflow Reference

For Claude Code • Problem Statement ID 26262

Project

Integrated AICTE Approval Workflow Automation, Compliance Monitoring and Alert Management System

Why this file exists

This is a compact, implementation-oriented brief of the APH provisions most relevant to our project. It is deliberately not the entire handbook. It also separates source-derived regulatory process summaries from the workflow we propose to implement.

How Claude should use this pack

- Retry the official AICTE handbook URL first: AICTE APH 2024-25 to 2026-27.
- If the official URL remains unavailable, use this PDF and the companion Markdown file as a selected source summary; do not invent missing regulatory rules.
- Treat the included workflow PNG as a visual reference, not as a legal source. The written route constraints take precedence over any ambiguous connector in the image.
- Any item labelled unverified or demo-only must not be published as an official rule.

Source status — read before coding

The official AICTE URL did not load reliably during preparation. Relevant passages were cross-checked in a mirror copy of the same titled handbook. The mirror is not the issuing authority. The exact wording and current applicability must be verified against AICTE's official source before regulatory configuration is published.

A secondary legal update reports a corrigendum dated 2 December 2025 changing the EVC definition/constitution and SAC constitution. The official primary corrigendum was not verified in this preparation. This remains a critical verification gap: do not encode the reported change as confirmed until the primary official document is obtained.

Design rule: software receives, organises, flags and tracks evidence. Authorised AICTE bodies perform the regulatory scrutiny, inspection and decisions reserved to them.

Prepared: 26 October 2026 • This is a project reference brief, not legal advice or an official AICTE publication.

1. Selected APH provisions

These summaries are grounded in the APH headings and clauses below. Printed page numbers refer to the numbering shown in the handbook.

Chapter I, clause 1.8 — Scrutiny / Re-scrutiny (printed pp. 7–8)

- The handbook describes committee selection through an AICTE portal-based automated selection process and says the Regulation Bureau communicates the scrutiny/re-scrutiny schedule.
- Deficiencies identified by scrutiny are communicated to the applicant through the AICTE portal.
- Re-scrutiny checks only the deficiencies pointed out by the Scrutiny Committee under the applicable norms and standards.
- Cases found in order after scrutiny/re-scrutiny are processed further for EVC when the applicable route requires it.
- Scrutiny/re-scrutiny and EVC processing should be recorded for transparency and accountability; the handbook notes online processing with offline processing permitted in extraordinary circumstances.

Chapter I, clause 1.9 — EVC (printed pp. 8–9)

- The handbook describes portal-based automated selection of EVC members and verification of the institution’s facilities/infrastructure, relevant documents and faculty-related readiness as applicable.
- EVC proceedings and reporting are part of the recorded process; scrutiny/re-scrutiny and EVC reports are made available through the AICTE portal under the described process.

Chapter I, clause 1.10 — Grant of approval (printed pp. 8–9)

- The Executive Committee considers committee recommendations and Regulation Bureau views and decides whether to grant approval. The handbook states EC decisions are ratified by the Council.
- Official outputs include LoA, LoD or LoR, as applicable; the handbook describes a speaking order with specific rejection reasons for LoR.

Chapter I, clause 1.11 — Appeal procedure (printed pp. 9–10)

- The clause describes a one-time portal appeal to the Council for an institution/applicant aggrieved by the Executive Committee decision, considered by SAC, with applicable scrutiny/EVC reports and Regulation Bureau observations placed before SAC.
- This clause’s text states a 7-day period measured from the date of issue of LoD. Do not treat this as a universal appeal trigger for every application category.

Implementation consequence

A successful upload, clean OCR extraction or complete checklist is not official verification. The system can prepare evidence and flag issues, but the authorised officer decides the significance of issues and the competent authority records the decision.

2. Chapter II routes, SHC and appeals

Chapter II, clauses 2.23–2.24 (printed pp. 29–30)

- Clause 2.23.1 points to Chapter I clause 1.8 for scrutiny/re-scrutiny as applicable and refers to Table 2.3 for the category-specific process.
- Clause 2.23.2 describes EVC subsequent to scrutiny/re-scrutiny when the applicable Table 2.3 route calls for it.
- Clause 2.23.3 gives institutions an opportunity to submit compliance for shortcomings based on scrutiny/re-scrutiny/EVC before SHC. SHC recommendations are placed before the Executive Committee.
- Clause 2.24 describes a one-time appeal to the Council within 7 days of uploading the Executive Committee decision. SAC considers the appeal; SAC recommendations go to the Council, whose decision is final as described in the handbook.

Appeal deadline: do not use one global timer

Chapter I clause 1.11 and Chapter II clause 2.24 use differently worded triggers. Store the deadline basis and duration in a versioned policy tied to the applicable clause and category. If applicability is ambiguous, send it to authorised review rather than guessing.

Table 2.3 — selected route examples (printed p. 30)

Application type	Self-disclosure	Scrutiny / re-scrutiny	EVC	SAC / SHC
Extension of Approval based on self-disclosure	Yes	—	—	—
Change in institution name / affiliating University or Board / relevant type change	—	Yes	—	—
Increase in intake / additional courses	—	Yes	Yes	AA
Start new programme/level in an existing institution	—	Yes	Yes	AA
Change course name / merger of courses / reduction in intake	—	Yes	—	—

AA means “As Applicable Depending on the Outcome of the Previous Processing Steps.” Table 2.3 is not one universal route; it lists category-specific routes within Chapter II.

Role separation

EVC produces findings/report; SHC is a compliance/hearing process for shortcomings where applicable; SAC considers an eligible appeal; the Executive Committee/Council decision process remains the authorised decision path prescribed by the applicable rules. These roles must not be conflated.

3. Proposed six-stage product workflow

This is our proposed software flow, not a verbatim statement that the APH has exactly six stages. The applicable APH category and verified current rules decide which stages occur and in what order.

STAGE	FLOW / CONTROL POINTS
Stage 1 — Intake & initial validation	Institute submits form/files → authenticate and verify scope → check fields and file safety → detect duplicates → register application ID and preserve originals.
Stage 2 — Document intelligence & evidence validation	Load approved rule version/checklist → extract digital PDF text/OCR → record fields with page references and confidence → check completeness and consistency. NO unresolved issue goes directly to scrutiny. YES issue is routed: draft correction where permitted; formal submission potential deficiency goes to the authorised officer.
Stage 3 — Authorised scrutiny / re-scrutiny	Officer reviews original evidence, checklist, source references and flags → records findings/reasons → if further information is required, authorised deficiency process → institution response/new version/revalidation → re-scrutiny. Re-scrutiny must not auto-pass.
Stage 4 — Conditional EVC / SHC	Approved route and case outcome determine applicability and order. EVC if required: authorised selection/scheduling → visit/verification → report. SHC where applicable: institute compliance → review/hearing → recommendations. Never force every case through both; neither report is final approval.
Stage 5 — Executive Committee decision	Complete case record with scrutiny findings, EVC/SHC results where applicable and Regulation Bureau observations → authorised decision → record official outcome → notify institution → permitted status sync only through authorised integration. Failed sync remains pending and is reconciled.
Stage 6 — Eligible SAC appeal & continuing compliance	If eligible and aggrieved: appeal via prescribed process → SAC review → Council decision where prescribed → update final status. NO appeal bypasses SAC. Both outcomes converge at a separate “Any continuing compliance obligations?” decision. Track obligations only where applicable and close only after required verification.

Mandatory decision-logic checks

- Stage 2 “Any unresolved issue?” NO → directly to scrutiny review. It must never lead to a deficiency notice.
- A formal deficiency notice is an authorised officer action, not an OCR action.
- After institute correction, create a new document version, revalidate and return to scrutiny/re-scrutiny.
- EVC/SHC are conditional and not universally parallel. The rule engine must select the prescribed next stage.
- SAC is an appeal path after the applicable Executive Committee decision. Appeal and post-decision compliance are separate.
- No application is approved/rejected automatically by OCR, checklist completion or EVC findings.

4. Controls, dashboards and source gaps

Cross-cutting controls

- Role-based access: enforce institution/region/assignment scopes in the backend.
- Versioned rules: existing submitted applications keep the rule version/snapshot used at submission; new rules do not silently rewrite historical cases.
- SLA/deadline engine: persist clock start, due date, status and policy version; separate statutory deadlines from internal SLAs; pause/resume only when policy permits.
- Notifications: receipt/assignment, authorised deficiency notices and response deadlines, EVC scheduling, upcoming/due/overdue reminders, decisions, eligible appeals, compliance and document-expiry alerts.
- Audit/recovery: actor, timestamp, action, reason, rule version and document version; idempotent retries, reconciliation after failures, and preserve original files/history.

Dashboards / users

Dashboard	Purpose
Institute	Own applications, checklist, uploaded files, correction notices, deadlines, decisions, eligible appeal and compliance status.
Scrutiny officer	Assigned cases, originals, extracted values/page references, issues, findings, deficiency/re-scrutiny and due tasks.
EVC coordinator / selection workflow	Cases requiring EVC, current authorised selection status, scheduling, progress, rescheduling and reports.
EVC member	Assigned cases, documents, visit instructions, observations, evidence and report submission.
SHC	Applicable compliance submissions, hearing/review records and recommendations.
Bureau / Executive Committee	Complete case record, committee reports, Regulation Bureau observations and authorised decision actions.
SAC / appeal workflow	Eligible appeals, decision record, supporting evidence, hearing/review and Council outcome.
Rules admin / approver / auditor	Source-linked rule drafts, review/publication controls, version history and scoped read-only audit access. Rule-edit access does not confer approval authority.

Critical verification gaps

1. Re-check the current official APH and applicable official corrigenda before publishing rule data. 2. A secondary legal update reports a 2 December 2025 amendment to EVC/SAC constitution and EVC modes; the primary official corrigendum was not verified during this preparation. 3. The Chapter I and Chapter II appeal clauses use different deadline triggers. 4. Do not invent SLA durations, document checklists, route conditions, role permissions or escalation ladders.

Source register

Primary target: AICTE, Approval Process Handbook 2024-25 to 2026-27. Official PDF URL. Relevant printed pages: 7–10 (Chapter I 1.8–1.11), 29–30 (Chapter II 2.23–2.24 and Table 2.3).

Mirror inspected for this summary, not the issuing authority: APH 2024-27 mirror PDF.

Secondary corrigendum report requiring primary confirmation: TeamLease RegTech update (reported 21 February 2026; says corrigendum dated 2 December 2025).

Official launch background: Press Information Bureau, 6 December 2023.

This document summarises selected provisions for software planning. The official handbook, applicable corrigenda and portal notices control in case of conflict. Verify before encoding production rules.